

1.3 Troubleshooting Power Supply Units (PSUs)

Among all the PC components, the power supply is the most dangerous. It converts the 240V wall voltage into smaller 12V, 5V and 3.3V DC allocations required by the PC. Usually, the power supply comes with the cabinet and is backed by a warranty so you shouldn't have problems. However, it pays to be careful and take the extra effort to verify the quality of the power supply. If you are purchasing it separately, opt for a brand name. Check around with your friends, the Internet and other system



A PSU with all its connectors

builders. Horror stories of faulty PSUs that blow up and ruin entire PCs are common, so be careful. A good quality PSU will not only give your system a long life span, it will also help reduce the noise and heat generated inside the cabinet. Some common problems you may face with PSUs are:

1.3.1 The power doesn't come on

1. **No power from the wall socket:** Use a live power outlet. In rare cases, the power cable may be defective and may require replacement. Check the power cable on another working PC. Plug in a lamp or any other electric device to see if you have a live outlet.
2. **Incorrect voltage setting on the PSU:** Select the proper voltage setting (220-240V) on the back of the PSU. **WARNING:** If you have switched on the PC with the voltage set to 110-120V and with a mains supply of 240V you may have blown your PSU beyond repair at worst or blown a fuse at best. Be careful!
3. **The front panel power switch's connector to the motherboard is not fixed correctly or has come off or is defective:** Check the motherboard manual and fix the lead (wires) from the front panel switch to the motherboard correctly. If there is still no power, try a different lead.
4. **The front panel power switch is defective:** Replace the switch. In case you do not want to get a replacement, one option is to use the reset button. The only problem with this is that to cut the